Michael Hinderman

Solution-driven security engineering manager with 10 years of experience across security operations, detection and response, and SecOps automation. Deep expertise in SIEM/SOAR architecture and deployment (Cortex XSOAR/XSIAM, Splunk, QRadar) and Python automation, with integration experience across the modern enterprise security stack: EDR, identity, ITSM, cloud, and network tooling. Currently lead enterprise SecOps platform Customer Success engagements at Palo Alto Networks, translating business risk and operational requirements into production detection and response workflows.

TECHNICAL SKILLS

Automation & Development: Python, Bash, JavaScript, REST API integration development, AI-assisted workflow automation

SIEM / SOAR: Cortex XSOAR, Cortex AgentiX, Cortex XSIAM, Splunk, IBM QRadar; detection content, playbook development, data-source onboarding

Endpoint & Analysis: Cortex XDR, CylancePROTECT/OPTICS, FireEye AX, Wireshark (PCAP forensics), Tanium

Response Domains: Phishing response, threat hunting, identity/MFA response, IOC correlation, DLP, cloud remediation, ITSM orchestration (ServiceNow)

Infrastructure: Proxmox, OPNsense, Active Directory, DNS, Ubiquiti/UniFi, AWS (reverse proxy, VPN), NAS and backup architecture, AlienVault USM, Vectra

AI: Claude Code, Gemini CLI, Codex, IDEX, Ollama

EXPERIENCE

Palo Alto Networks — Engineering Manager, Cortex Deployment (Customer Success Engineering) *Mar 2025 – Present | Remote*

- Own a 300+ customer portfolio across 8 Cortex products (XSIAM, XSOAR, XDR, Xpanse, AgentiX, Prisma Cloud, Cortex Cloud); segmented the book to prioritize the top 20% by value, holding account health steady across that tier for two years with zero regressions.
- Architected an AI portfolio-intelligence portal on Google Cloud, Gemini, and Apps Script that fuses engineer engagement notes, customer tenant telemetry, and support case data into queryable, near-real-time account narratives for managers; adopted by the internal tools team and now used by the Customer Success executive team.
- Restructured the team from an eight-product generalist model into specialized sub-roles (Technical Account Manager, Delivery Engineer, Content & Scale), routing customer engagement through a defined process to cut context switching and depth-of-expertise gaps.
- Kept priority-account risk well under leadership's target; personally intervened on an at-risk enterprise renewal to reverse churn risk.
- Lead a 14-engineer team deploying XSOAR/XSIAM detection and response workflows into enterprise SecOps environments; doubled the production go-live target for the half, with over half of those reaching multi-use-case production.
- Designed a deployment engagement framework with a 3-engineer taskforce that cut first-use-case time from months to a day and raised deployment rates.
- Standardized production playbook frameworks for phishing response, threat hunting, cloud remediation, DLP, and network/firewall use cases.
- Drove an XSIAM cross-training program; 50% of the team earned XSIAM Analyst certification.
- Automated the audit of 1,200+ unstructured task records via AI-driven workflows during a tooling gap, saving 40+ manual hours; instituted documentation standards across 1,500+ activity records mapped to customer journey milestones.

Palo Alto Networks — Principal Engineer (prior: Senior Technical Lead, Customer Success Engineer) *Mar 2020 – Mar 2025 | Remote*

- Deployed XSOAR to production in 29 enterprise environments with playbooks for endpoint response, identity/MFA lockout, IOC correlation, and ITSM orchestration; brought a large bank's deployment, stalled ~12 months on a Docker-to-Podman migration in an air-gapped network, into live production.
- Developed custom XSOAR integrations in Python against customer REST APIs across EDR, identity, ticketing, and threat intelligence platforms to close detection and response coverage gaps.
- Primary technical escalation point for a 14-engineer team and the broader Cortex org while carrying the team's highest client volume.

- Acting CSE Manager for two months (1:1s, workload balancing, escalations, executive reporting), preceding promotion.
- Designed the org-wide UAT and upgrade tracking system adopted for XSOAR 6→8 SaaS migrations; co-led a 3-engineer taskforce that re-engaged the majority of a large set of dormant environments.
- Onboarded and mentored 50% of new engineering hires via shadowing and technical training programs.
- Authored a public technical training video series on LiveCommunity (incident lifecycles, pre-processing, classification/mapping, integration setup).
- Ran cross-functional hackathons (16–20 engineers and architects) that eliminated deployment workflow bottlenecks.

BlackBerry Cylance — CFC Analyst / Engineer *Mar 2019 – Mar 2020 | Plano, TX*

- Developed Python automation for alert ingestion, URL/domain/IP analysis, phishing analysis, report generation, and Splunk/Tanium integration; cut phishing analysis time from up to 45 minutes to under 15 and made the case that led the team to adopt Demisto.
- Designed a Demisto (XSOAR) playbook tier system adopted into production; built end-to-end playbooks automating analysis of Splunk-sourced alerts and authored the team's SOAR development standards (automations, playbooks, jobs, incident templates, integrations).
- Performed detection, triage, and remediation of security alerts across platforms using Splunk and ServiceNow; ran on-demand threat hunting engagements and produced threat reports for leadership.
- Investigated incident severity via PCAP analysis in Wireshark from FireEye AX detonations.

Wipro Limited (MSSP) — SOC L3, Network Forensics Lead *Jun 2017 – Mar 2019 | Dallas, TX / client sites*

- Led the SOC Network Forensics team within Incident Response for a 60-person fusion center; delivered breach forensics and reporting for healthcare (removable/disk drive analysis) and manufacturing (multi-cloud platform analysis) clients.
- Monitored and tuned QRadar SIEM offenses; developed detection use cases and analysis procedures for L1/L2 analysts.
- Executed a 3-month on-site audit remediation for a global bank: remediated 50+ findings spanning endpoint protection, VLAN segregation, hardware decommissioning, ACL monitoring, and process documentation; bank passed audit at engagement close.
- Authored the technical build-out process and analyst workflow manual for a new SOC at a major streaming media provider; ran monthly requirement and status reviews with the security director and CISO.
- Built and delivered SOC analyst training (access control, networking, Python, Linux, forensics); supported a multi-domain SOC lab (QRadar, Vectra, Demisto, simulated malware/forensic networks).

Cyber Defense Labs — SOC Intern *May 2016 – Jun 2017 | Richardson, TX*

- Monitored security alerts in AlienVault USM and produced incident reports; supported red team engagements with Kali Linux drop boxes and social engineering exercises; assisted deployment of virtual firewall appliances in a Dallas data center.

HOME LAB & INDEPENDENT WORK

- Operate a self-hosted enterprise-style environment on Proxmox: OPNsense firewalls with segmented main/guest networks (Ubiquiti mesh), Active Directory, DNS, and a dedicated pentest lab.
- Run a local XSOAR instance for playbook and integration development outside of work engagements.
- Designed remote access via an AWS-hosted reverse proxy fronting a locally hosted VPN; maintain NAS with cold-storage backup strategy.

CERTIFICATIONS

- Palo Alto Networks XSOAR Engineer (2024) - Active
- PCSAE — Palo Alto Networks Certified Security Automation Engineer (2021) - Inactive
- SANS GIAC Network Forensic Analyst (GNFA), Analyst #1571 (2018) - Inactive

EDUCATION

University of North Texas — B.S. Information Technology *2012 – 2017 | Denton, TX*

- VP, Engineering Dept. Cyber Security Club; Collegiate Cyber Defense Competition competitor (2016, 2017); designed a 10-stage CTF and led training on buffer overflows, WiFi exploitation, Linux, and Python.